



5.05 Restricted Work Space

Objectives

Workers are challenged by having to perform work in restricted movement, access and exit of workspaces as a part of working every day. The worker must review each day and situation as a new workplace, determining all of the hazards each and every time. Complacency in performing this task of ensuring that your workspace allows for work to be performed with minimum restrictions of movement is an invitation to something that will go wrong.

Scope

The following will provide guidelines for the worker or workers to review to determine if they have addressed all of the hazards:

Hazard Assessment & Identification

1. **CONFINED SPACE:** Is the workspace a confined space? One entrance and exit, contained space and atmosphere deficiency?

Definition: Confined Space means a restricted space which may become hazardous to a worker entering it because of:

- a. an atmosphere that is or may be injurious by reason of oxygen deficiency or enrichment, flammability, explosivity, or toxicity,
- b. a condition or changing set of circumstances within the space that presents a potential for injury or illness, or
- c. the potential or inherent characteristics of an activity which can produce adverse or harmful consequences within the space.
- d. a Confined Space procedure process must be implemented and documented on Confined Space permit.

2. **RESTRICTED SPACE:** Is the workspace a restricted space? Enclosed area, in tight space, where movement is restricted and or impeded?

Definition: Restricted Space means an enclosed or partially enclosed space, not designed, or intended for continuous human occupancy. That has a restricted, limited, or impeded means of entry or exit because of its construction. Entry requirements may be less stringent than the requirements for a "confined space".

1. A Field Level Hazard Assessment must be performed, all equipment must be locked out and locked down, no movement of equipment is permitted.

3. **PLATFORM STABILITY:** Does the workspace allow for freedom of access and or movement? Workers movement is restricted by objects, material, elevations, and instability.



Definition: Platform Instability means restricted impeded worker foot stability and or movement. Platforms that do not accommodate movement by foot freely and or the stability of the platform is compromised, that it could or will fail from the weight of a worker.

1. A Field Level Hazard Assessment must be performed, all areas must allow freedom of movement by clearing of objects and or material. Elevations and instability must be made accessible by providing access methods: ladders, man lift and walkways.

4. ELEVATED WORK PLATFORM: Work at an elevation beyond ground level; means work in any place, including a place at or below ground level or when a person is accessing or exiting from such a place (except via a building code staircase to and from a permanent workplace) where if fall protection measures are not taken, a person could fall a distance beyond body height, that would likely cause injury.

- a. Avoid work at an elevation.
- b. When work on an elevated work platform must be performed, a field level hazard assessment must be performed.
- c. If work on an elevated work platform cannot be avoided, prevent falls by selecting and using the right access equipment.
- d. Where you cannot eliminate the risk of a fall, use work equipment or other means to minimize the distance and consequences of a fall should one occur.
- e. All work on an elevated work platform must be properly planned and organized.
- f. Ensure that emergencies and rescue procedures are planned for.

5. ACCESS TO AN ELEVATED WORKPLACE: Access can be stairs, steps and or a ladder Accessing a location to perform work with the use stairs, steps and or a ladder, must be engineered in such a way that the worker has the ability to implement three points of contact from the start to end.

- a. Three points of contact must be achievable and used.
- b. Steps must be within Regulatory, Canadian Safety Association and or Building Code Standards.
- c. Railings, handles must be within Regulatory, Canadian Safety Association and or building code standards.
- d. When the access to an elevated work platform exceeds regulatory requirements. A fall protection system must be selected and implemented.

Equipment

Various equipment, structures, containers and or buildings

Client Authorization

- As with all Silverpoint projects, ensure that authorization to enter the location is in place and that the Client's site Supervisor is aware of your activities.
- Any deviation from detailed treatment plans or procedures will require client or Silverpoint Supervisor approval.



EHS Requirements

Equipment and supplies as outlined in the procedure. Personal protective equipment: fireproof coveralls, hard hat, safety glasses, steel toed boots, gloves, ear protection (if necessary). Organic vapor cartridge respirator (if needed).

Safety Practices

As with any procedure carried out for Silverpoint , employees and contractors must consider the hazards involved in every task undertaken, assess the level of risk and take appropriate precautions.

Remember: if you are in doubt about what to do, call your supervisor